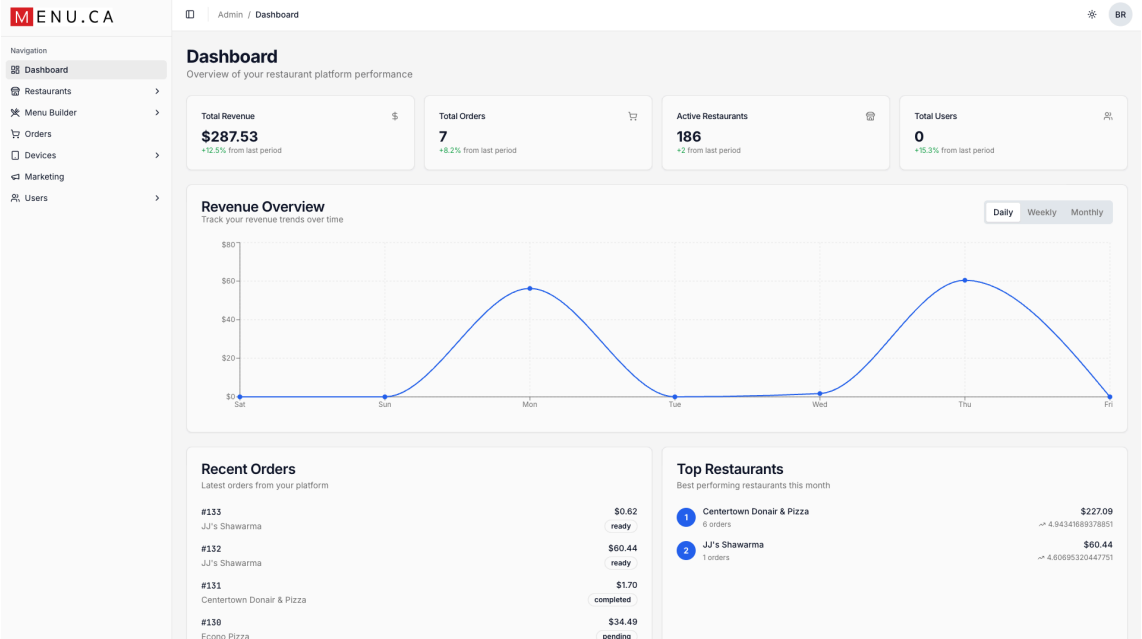


Menu Builder Guide

Your complete guide to creating and managing your restaurant menu on Menu.ca



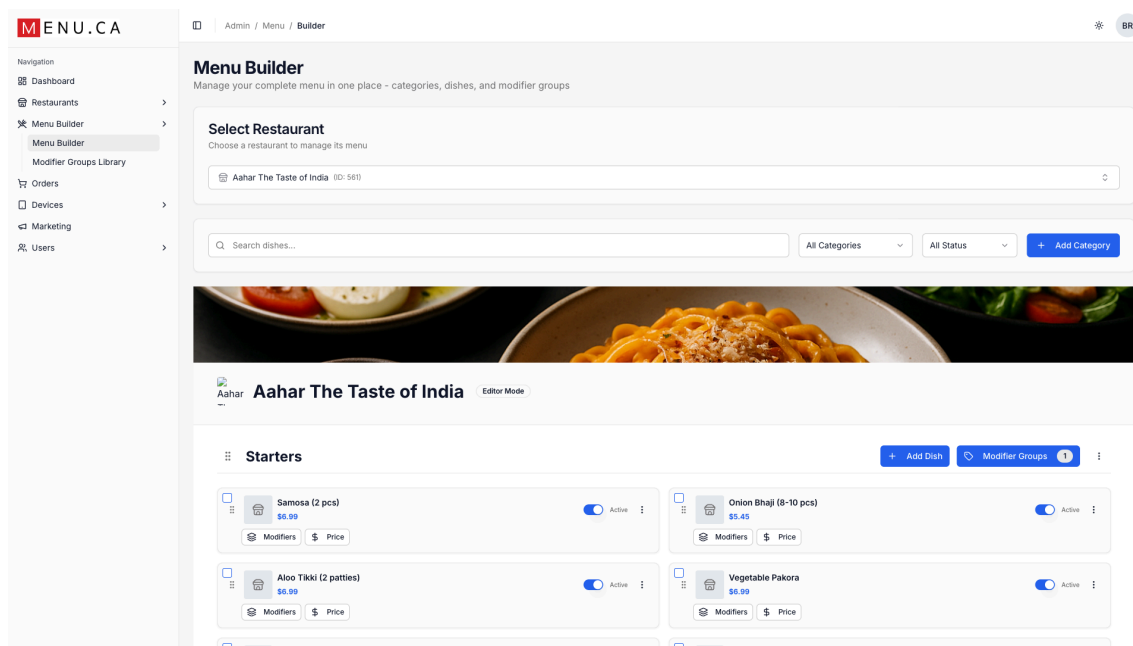
The Menu.ca Dashboard - Your restaurant management hub

Getting Started

The Menu Builder is your central hub for managing everything your customers see when ordering. From this single interface, you can add dishes, set prices, organize categories, and configure modifiers.

Accessing Menu Builder

1. Log in to your Menu.ca admin dashboard
2. Click **Menu Builder** in the left navigation
3. Select your restaurant from the dropdown (if you manage multiple locations)



Menu Builder showing categories and dishes

Managing Categories

Categories help organize your menu into logical sections that customers can easily browse. Common categories include Appetizers, Main Courses, Desserts, Beverages, and Specials.

Creating a New Category

1. Click the **+ Add Category** button
2. Enter a category name (e.g., 'Lunch Specials')
3. Optionally add a description
4. Set the display order (lower numbers appear first)
5. Click **Save**

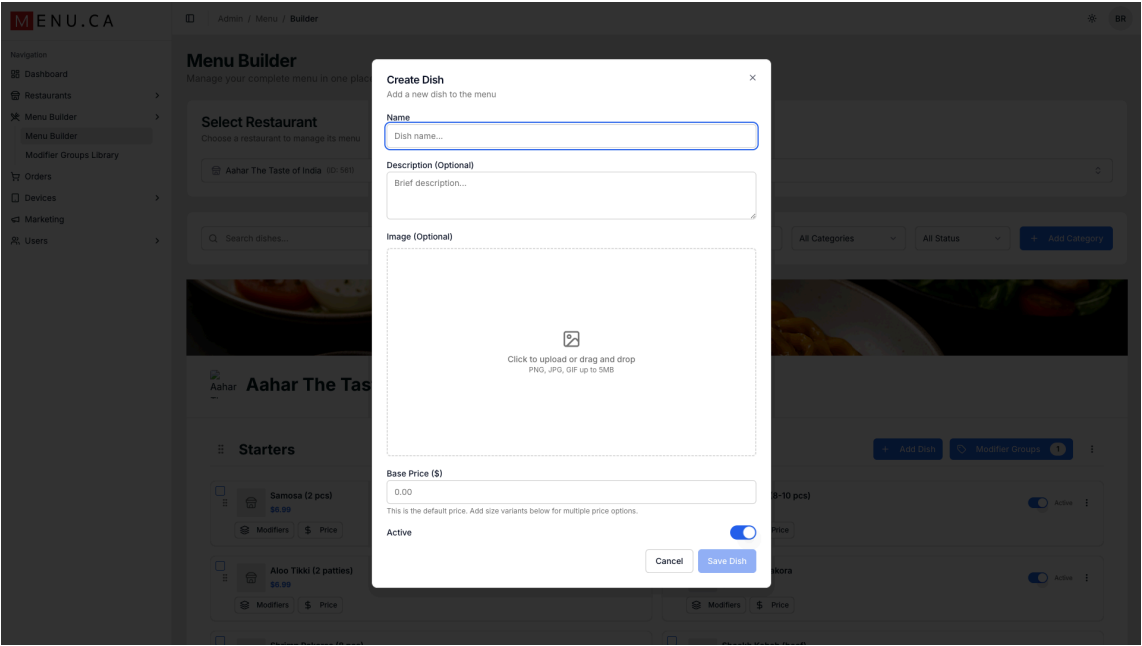
Tip: Use clear, descriptive category names. 'Lunch Specials (11am-3pm)' is more helpful than just 'Specials'.

Category Features

Feature	Description
Drag & Drop	Reorder categories by dragging them
Active Toggle	Show/hide entire categories
Add Dish	Add dishes directly to a category
Modifier Groups	Attach modifier groups to all dishes in a category

Adding Dishes

Each dish on your menu needs essential information: a name, price, and category. You can also add descriptions, images, and modifiers to give customers all the details they need.



The Add Dish dialog with all available options

Required Fields

Field	Description	Example
Dish Name	What customers see on the menu	Classic Pepperoni Pizza
Price	Base price before modifiers	\$14.99
Category	Which menu section it appears in	Pizza

Optional Fields

Field	Description
Description	Appetizing details about the dish
French Translation	Name/description in French for bilingual menus
Image	Photo of the dish (recommended: 800x600px)
Active Toggle	Show/hide dish on the menu
Modifiers	Attach modifier groups for customization

Dish Card Controls

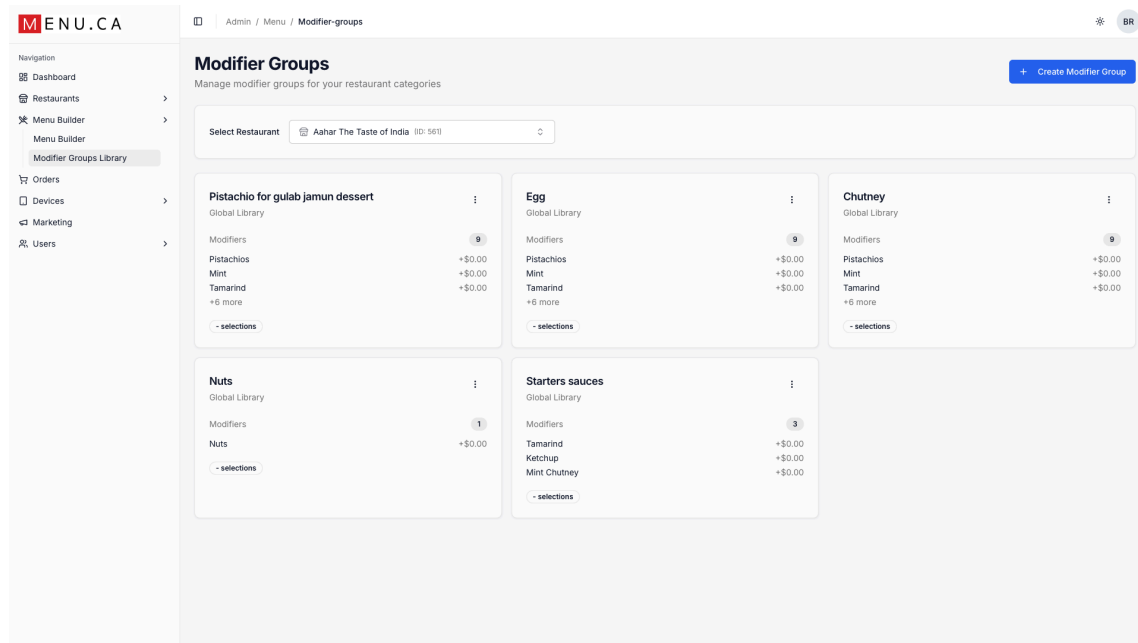
Each dish card in the Menu Builder shows:

- **Active toggle** - Blue = visible to customers

- **Modifiers button** - Shows count of attached modifier groups
- **Price button** - Quick edit for pricing
- **: Menu** - Edit, duplicate, or delete

Modifier Groups

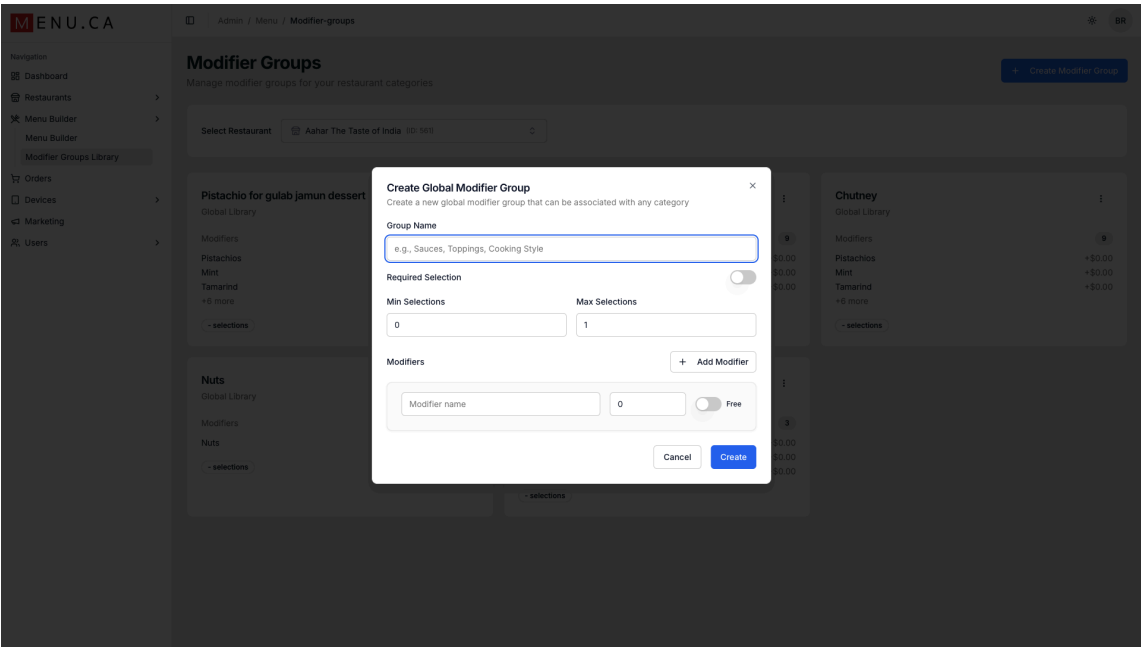
Modifiers let customers customize their orders - think pizza toppings, drink sizes, or cooking preferences. The Modifier Groups Library stores reusable modifier sets you can apply to multiple dishes.



Your library of reusable modifier groups

Creating a Modifier Group

1. Navigate to **Menu Builder → Modifier Groups Library**
2. Click **+ Create Modifier Group**
3. Enter a group name (e.g., 'Pizza Toppings')
4. Set selection rules (min/max selections, required or optional)
5. Add individual modifiers with their prices
6. Click **Create**



Creating a new modifier group

Modifier Group Settings

Setting	Description	Example
Group Name	What customers see	"Choose Your Toppings"
Required Selection	Must customer choose?	Toggle on for required
Min Selections	Minimum choices	0 for optional, 1+ for required
Max Selections	Maximum choices	3 for "pick up to 3"

Modifier Options

For each modifier in a group:

Field	Description
Name	The option name (e.g., "Extra Cheese")
Price	Additional cost (\$0.00 for free options)
Free Toggle	Mark as included at no extra charge

Best Practices

Menu Organization Tips

- **Keep it simple:** 5-7 categories maximum works best for most restaurants
- **Lead with your best:** Put popular items at the top of each category

- **Use appetizing descriptions:** 'Hand-breaded crispy chicken tenders' sells better than 'Chicken strips'
- **Price strategically:** Avoid ending prices in .99 for upscale items

Modifier Best Practices

- **Group logically:** Keep related modifiers together (all toppings in one group)
- **Set sensible limits:** If pizza comes with 3 toppings, set max selections to 3 for free toppings
- **Price add-ons fairly:** Customers expect premium toppings to cost more
- **Use 'Free' toggle:** Mark included items as free so customers know the value

Tip: Review your menu on a mobile device! Most customers order from their phones, so make sure descriptions aren't too long and prices are easy to read.

Quick Reference

Navigation

Location	How to Get There
Menu Builder	Sidebar → Menu Builder → Menu Builder
Modifier Groups	Sidebar → Menu Builder → Modifier Groups Library
Edit a Dish	Click dish card → : menu → Edit
Add Category	Menu Builder → + Add Category button

Common Tasks

Task	Steps
Add a dish	Select category → Click "Add Dish" → Fill form → Save
Edit price	Click "Price" button on dish card → Enter new price → Save
Hide a dish	Click the blue toggle on dish card (turns gray when hidden)
Attach modifiers	Click "Modifiers" on dish card → Select groups → Save
Reorder dishes	Drag dishes by the :: handle on the left

Keyboard Shortcuts

Shortcut	Action
Esc	Close modal/dialog
Enter	Save/confirm (when in form)
Tab	Move to next field

Troubleshooting

Dish Not Showing on Menu?

1. Check the **Active toggle** is blue (on)
2. Verify the **Category** is also active
3. Confirm you selected the right **Restaurant** in the dropdown

Modifiers Not Appearing?

1. Ensure the modifier group is **attached to the dish**
2. Check the modifier group has at least one modifier added
3. Verify prices are set (even \$0.00 for free options)

Changes Not Saving?

1. Look for validation errors (red text under fields)
2. Ensure required fields are filled
3. Try refreshing the page and re-entering

Need help? Contact support at support@menu.ca